

Charlemagne's crown was used in the coronation of every French king until 1722.

The great teacher

Charlemagne was appalled by how few people in France were able to **read and write**—even many of the country's priests were illiterate. He called in **SCHOLARS** from Britain and Ireland to restore the schools of France. He also organized a school at his royal palace at Aachen (in modern-day Germany), and introduced **monastic schools** all over Europe.



Charlemagne would visit his new schools to make sure they reached his standards.

Shaping Europe

Charlemagne took a group of squabbling and separate Frankish kingdoms and laid the foundations for the unified country of France. His empire encouraged the emergence of a more enlightened and better educated Europe.

He paved the way for...

Charlemagne saw himself as the heir to the **ROMAN EMPIRE** when he was crowned emperor in 800. His successors became known as **HOLY ROMAN EMPERORS**, and the title survived until 1805.

NAPOLEON (1769–1821) wanted to recreate Charlemagne's military and administrative achievements by creating a "modern" **FRENCH EMPIRE**.